

To recap, the following steps should be taken when joint debts become separated:

1. Realize that you cannot take your name off the account as long as a balance remains, even if the account was assigned by the court to your ex-spouse.
2. Cut up the credit cards. This will prevent further usage.
3. Close the accounts (write a letter to the creditor asking to stop any additional activity on the card). This will show up as “closed at consumer’s request” on your credit report.
4. Request a copy of your credit report periodically to check activity on any accounts not under your control.
5. If the creditor comes after you because of your spouse’s nonpayment, do not ignore them.
6. Don’t forget that ultimately joint accounts are both parties’ responsibility.

Too Poor to Divorce

Divorce can lead to financial problems in many instances. In fact, according to the U.S. Census Bureau, less than half of the custodial parents who were due child support received the full amount of their court-ordered child support payments. Mothers were due \$26.4 billion and fathers \$2.7 billion. This shows that the unsupplemented burden of child and household support falls more often to women with single incomes and can result in a decline in their lifestyle following a divorce. Additionally, men can also suffer if they have large alimony and/or child support payments to make. The reality is that the amount of money that once supported one household must now support two. There are now double the bills in most expense categories.

Prior to considering a divorce, the post divorce financial picture should be calculated. Estimate any anticipated changes

